
This act summary is provided for the convenience of the public and members of the General Assembly. It is intended to provide a general summary of the act and may not be exhaustive. It has been prepared by the staff of the Office of Legislative Counsel without input from members of the General Assembly. It is not intended to aid in the interpretation of legislation or to serve as a source of legislative intent.

Act No. 163 (H.952). An act relating to capital construction and State bonding budget adjustment

Subjects: Capital construction; State bonding; budget adjustment

This act adjusts the State's biennial capital budget for fiscal years 2026 and 2027.

Bond-Funded Project Authorizations. This act increases bond-funded project authorizations for the State's biennial capital budget by \$11,599,336.23, including the following adjustments:

- a reduction of \$1,616,586.82 for State Buildings
- an increase of \$10,025,104.21 for Human Services
- an increase of \$220,000.00 for Commerce and Community Development
- an increase of \$1,250,000.00 for Veterans' Home
- an increase of \$1,720,818.84 for Judiciary

Reallocations and Reversions. This act increases reallocations of bonded dollars and reversions of cash from prior capital appropriations by \$10,177,891.89 to fund projects authorized in this act.

Cash-Funded Project Authorizations. This act increases cash-funded project authorizations for the State's biennial capital budget by \$23,418,454.70, reflecting new spending authorizations in fiscal year 2027 for State Buildings, Human Services, Clean Water Initiatives, Public Safety, Judiciary, and Vermont Historical Society from the Capital Infrastructure subaccount of the Cash Fund for Capital and Essential Investments.

Department of Environmental Conservation. This act amends the chapter of Title 24 of the Vermont Statutes Annotated on the Special Environmental Revolving Fund to authorize the Vermont Economic Development Authority to extend private loans available to privately owned public water systems to eligible mobile home park water systems.

Division for Historic Preservation. This act amends the section of Title 22 of the Vermont Statutes Annotated on the acceptance of funds or gifts for historic sites and the Vermont Archaeology Heritage Center to authorize the State Historic Preservation Officer to solicit things of value on behalf of the Division for Historic Preservation with the approval of the Secretary of Administration.

Department of Forests, Parks and Recreation. This act authorizes the Commissioner of Forests, Parks and Recreation in fiscal year 2027 to enter into a long-term lease with the Vermont Huts Association Ltd. for the use of a structure and land at Little River State Park if certain conditions are met.

Department of Buildings and General Services. This act repeals and replaces earlier authority for the Commissioner of Buildings and General Services to transfer to the Town

of Springfield a portion of the Southern State Correctional Facility property with new time-limited authority to transfer a portion of the property for purposes of economic development if certain conditions are met. This act also amends existing authority for the Commissioner of Buildings and General Services to sell the property located at 110 State Street in the City of Montpelier to require the property to be sold at fair market value; to require appropriate protective covenants; and to require notice to the Chairs of the House Committee on Corrections and Institutions and the Senate Committee on Institutions.

Agency of Human Services. This act requires the Department for Children and Families and the Department of Buildings and General Services to report on their plan to develop the Green Mountain Youth Facility to the Joint Legislative Justice Oversight Committee. This act also requires the Department of Buildings and General Services to submit design documents and the Department for Children and Families to submit a draft operating budget to the House Committees on Corrections and Institutions and on Human Services and the Senate Committees on Institutions and on Health and Welfare prior to formal approval.

Department of Corrections and Agency of Digital Services. This act requires the Commissioner of Corrections and the State Chief Information Officer of Digital Services to report regularly to the Joint Legislative Justice Oversight Committee on the plan for providing network connectivity in State correctional facilities.

Stormwater Utilities. This act amends the chapters of Title 24 of the Vermont Statutes Annotated on municipal and regional planning and development and on sewage, sewage disposal, and stormwater systems to ensure that existing municipal authority to regulate stormwater is not disrupted by the creation of a regional stormwater utility.

General Assembly. This act establishes a special committee consisting of the Joint Legislative Management Committee and the Chairs of the House Committee on Corrections and Institutions and the Senate Committee on Institutions to review the State House entryway design at a regularly scheduled Joint Legislative Management Committee meeting.

Effective Date: June 17, 2026